

GOSPEL × HOOPS

THE ULTIMATE COMEBACK



LIFE, BASKETBALL, AND GOD'S GAME PLAN FOR YOU

LUKE 15 • A GOSPEL TRACT



TIP-OFF

If there's one thing that gets a crowd on its feet, it's basketball—the fast break, the tight contest, the “heart” it takes to win.

But in the game of life, we're on the court too. Sometimes we forget to look to the Coach—and we're the ones who end up losing.

In Luke 15, the “sinners” crowd in to hear Jesus, and the religious grumble—why does he welcome them? Jesus answers with **three stories** about being “lost.” The last one has two brothers—so our game runs to four quarters.



Q1

Q2

Q3

Q4

LOST SHEEP

FIRST QUARTER

THE MISSING PLAYER

Every player matters to the Coach

LUKE 15:3-7

Picture a crucial game, and one of your starting five doesn't show. You'd go looking, wouldn't you? The team isn't whole when someone's missing.

In Jesus' story, a shepherd has a hundred sheep. When one wanders off, he leaves the ninety-nine to search until he finds it—then carries it home on his shoulders, overjoyed.

You're that lost sheep, and God is the Good Shepherd who won't stop looking for you. And heaven rejoices over one who comes home.

THE GOSPEL TRUTH

You're not an afterthought to God. He is actively pursuing you to bring you back to Himself.



Q1

Q2

Q3

Q4

LOST COIN

SECOND QUARTER

THE LOOSE BALL

Just how much you're worth to God

LUKE 15:8-10

In basketball there's the loose ball—it rolls away, looking like nobody's. Yet players dive after it and chase it down—they refuse to lose it.

In Jesus' story, a woman has ten silver coins and loses one. She lights a lamp, sweeps the whole house, and searches hard until she finds it—then calls the neighbours together to celebrate.

You're that coin. You weren't lost because you're worthless—you're searched for with everything, because you matter to Him.

THE GOSPEL TRUTH

Heaven rejoices over one who comes home. Your worth rests on belonging to Him—not on your performance.



Q1

Q2

Q3

Q4

YOUNGER BROTHER

THIRD QUARTER

THE COSTLY TURNOVER

The ultimate comeback story

LUKE 15:11–24

We all know the sting of a costly mistake—you turn the ball over, the team loses, and you can't even look at the coach.

The younger son demanded his inheritance and blew it all in a far-off place until he was ruined. Heading home he expected to be a mere servant—but while he was still far off, the father ran, embraced him, kissed him, and threw a feast!

"This son of mine was dead, and is alive again," said the father. That's how fast God runs toward anyone coming home.

THE GOSPEL TRUTH

This is what real repentance is—a 180-degree turn back to God, who is waiting with open arms.



Q1

Q2

Q3

Q4

OLDER BROTHER

FOURTH QUARTER

THE BITTER TEAMMATE

A solid team has no room for pride

LUKE 15:25–32

Think of the teammate who always turns up but never gets noticed. Then someone who'd been absent rolls in, drops 30, and takes all the praise. Bitterness sets in.

The older brother was furious that his returning brother got a welcome—he refused to join the party. So the father came out to plead: “Son, we had to celebrate—your brother was dead, and is alive!”

Turns out the older brother was “lost” too—in his pride and his own goodness.

THE GOSPEL TRUTH

You can do everything right and still miss salvation. It comes by God's grace alone—never by our own goodness.



00:00

THE FINAL BUZZER

TIME TO GET BACK IN THE **GAME**

Which son are you—the one who rebelled, or the one who thought he was good? The truth is, we're all "Prodigals." Both of us need the Father.

God is inviting you back. Not based on your stats—but on faith in Jesus, who stepped onto the court to take the penalty you owed: He died on the cross and rose again.



PUT ON THE "PRODIGAL JERSEY"

"I once was lost... but now I am found."

1

REPENT. Stop running your own plays. Admit you've sinned and that you need God.

2

TRUST. Put your full trust in Jesus as Lord and Saviour—not in your own ability, but in what He did on the cross.

READY TO ANSWER THE COACH?

Message any time—no judgement, just a friend.

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